

lesson

This noun refers to a period of teaching.

or**lessen**

This verb means to reduce.

She enjoyed her piano **lesson**.

I must **lessen** my grip on the rope.

weight

This noun refers to mass contained by an object.

or**wait**

This verb means to stay or delay an action.

The bag's **weight** is immense.

I must **wait** for my brother.

Commonly misspelled words

There are many other words that sound the same or similar to each other, but have different spellings and meanings. In all cases, it's important to use the correct word in order to be understood, particularly in written form. If uncertain which is the correct word to use, check a dictionary.

Word	Example sentence
are	Those boys are always getting into trouble.
hear	I could hear the plane flying overhead.
know	The taxi driver didn't know the way to my house.
lose	There was no way she could lose in the finals.
passed	He passed the present to his friend.
weather	The weather report predicted snowfall.

Word	Example sentence
our	Our team was invited to the national championships.
here	Here is the latest photo of my family.
now	There is now a café where my house used to be.
loose	My friend's loose change fell out of his pocket.
past	She drove past the park on the way home.
whether	I am not sure whether to wear my coat today or not.

One or two words?

Some phrases have different meanings according to whether they are spelled as one word or two. For example, the single word *everyday* means routine or commonplace, whereas *every day* means each day.

Word	Example sentence
anyone	Anyone caught smoking will be punished.
already	Our passports have already been inspected.
altogether	The song was altogether inappropriate.
everyday	I was wearing everyday clothes around the house.
maybe	Maybe one day they will uncover the truth.

Phrase	Example sentence
any one	Any one of those people could be to blame.
all ready	We are all ready to board the plane.
all together	The paintings were exhibited all together for the first time.
every day	I need to use a hairdryer every day after my shower.
may be	There may be more than one culprit.



• Learning the meanings of commonly used **roots**, **prefixes**, and **suffixes** can help with confusing words.